395 SQUADRON ALUMNI ASSOCIATION

Alumni Notes

395 Squadron Alumni Association Newsletter

August 2026

Celebrating Our Own: From 395 Squadron to National Recognition

This issue, the Alumni leadership is proud to celebrate the latest achievements of two members whose flying careers began right here at 395 Squadron: John Larsen, on the release of his second book, and Bud Granley, on his induction into the ICAS Foundation Hall of Fame. Both have been featured in previous issues of this Newsletter, and both continue to make our squadron proud.

John Larsen

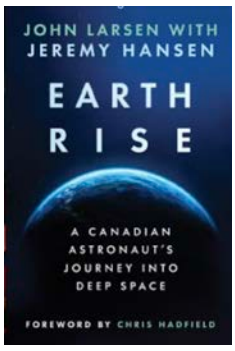


John's story is a familiar one to many of us: it began as a cadet at 395 Squadron. From there, he became an 395 Sqn officer eventually he became senior military public affairs officer for the CAF. He has since retired from the service.

Over the course of his military career, John has met and worked alongside many notable Canadians, but none more remarkable than Colonel Jeremy Hansen, who recently returned from his historic Artemis II mission around the Moon.



John's new book tells Jeremy's story, but of particular interest to our alumni is a dedicated chapter on Jeremy's time in air cadets , the foundational experiences and skills that helped set him on the path to becoming an astronaut. It's a powerful reminder of what this program can lead to.



The Alumni leadership encourages our membership to support John's book, especially for that chapter on the cadet movement and what it has meant to all of us who came through the program. The book is available for pre-order through Indigo: https://www.indigo.ca/prod-

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Congratulations, John, on your latest publication celebrating air cadets, aviation, and space.

80th Alumni Reunion Well Attended

Thank you to all of our alumni who attended the reunion on April 10, 2026. So new faces attended the reunion along many familiar alumni. The reunion was once again held at the Chateau Louis Hotel which was the former 700 Wing RCAFA building. Our guest speaker was Major Eddie Brown, CO of 395's affiliated unit, 417 Squadron. He talked about our relationship between the units and the long serving relationship lasting 33 years. Former COs attending were Maj Steve Wakeman, Capt Brittany Pilkington and Maj Brian Andrus with the current CO, Capt Deb Smart.

A big thank you to all for your work on this 80th Reunion. Thanks to the planning committee: Brian Andrus, Karen Butkowski, Kirby O'Connor, Raphael Mlynarski, Nick Nimchuk and the officers of 395 Sqn.





L to R: Lori Lautt, Ray Lautt, Joe Luce



Guest speaker for the reunion, Maj Eddie Brown, CO, 417 Sqn.



L to R: Damian Mlynarski, Raphael Mlynarski, David Jackson, Joe Luce

All the Commanding Officer since 1946 have been collected and published on our Alumni website. Link to the COs of 395 RCACS.



L to R: Capt Deb Smart, Capt Brittany Pilkington, Maj Brian Andrus and Maj Steven, Wakeman.



Bud Granley



Bud's flying journey also began as an air cadet at 395 Squadron, launching a career that would span decades. He went on to fly as a captain with a major airline, retiring as a 747 pilot in 1997 but that was far from the end of his flying story. For years afterward, Bud thrilled crowds across North America as a professional aerobatic pilot at air shows throughout the continent.

Bud retired from air show performing in August 2022, and the industry has now honoured him with one of its highest distinctions: induction into the 2025 ICAS Foundation Hall of Fame, recognizing a career spanning more than six decades in aviation.Read more from the ICAS Foundation: https://airshow-foundation.org/bud-granley/

This caps a long list of honours from his air show peers, including the Art Scholl Showmanship Award (2005) and the Bill Barber Showmanship Award (2008). Air show audiences will remember Bud at the controls of his T-6/Harvard, (painted in a striking Golden Hawk design), as well as his Yak-55 and Fouga Magister.



Aviation clearly runs in the family. Bud has six children, three of whom have served in the Canadian Armed Forces. Two flew with the Snowbirds aerobatic team and are now airline pilots: Ross with United, and Chris with Air Canada. Their sister Deb flies the 737 for Alaska Airlines. Their brother Bob chose the Navy and is now a Captain with BC Ferries, while also finding time to ferry the T-6 and Yak-55 to air shows.

A belated congratulations, Bud, on your retirement and your 2025 ICAS Hall of Fame induction and thank you for everything you've contributed to the aviation community, starting from your grass roots as an air cadet at 395 Squadron.

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417 Squadron - Squadron Re-designation

Squadron Re-designation (Early 2026): The unit transitioned from a Combat Support Squadron into a designated Domestic Response Squadron under Major Eddie Brown's leadership.

The squadron has also had to move several times over the past 5 years. From their original hanger to AETE hanger then to the 419 Hanger at the south end of the base. Their new home will be the former hanger which occupied 401 Squadron. 395 Sqn has a 33 year affiliation with 417 Sqn.



Maj Krista Feniak

Welcome to the new Commanding Officer of 417 Squadron, Maj Krista Feniak, and MWO Jamie Bramwell. The Alumni looks forward to collaborating with the squadron and their ongoing support of the cadets at 395 Squadron. *Ad Astra*



MWO James Bramwell

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